



Strategy & Operations

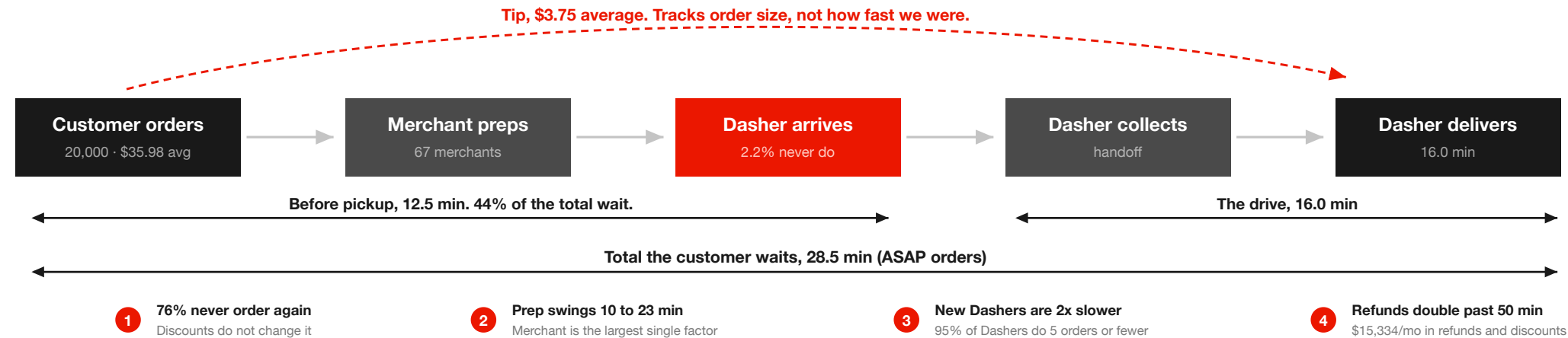
Case Study

September 2024

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Every order crosses three parties and four handoffs. The pain points cluster in one stretch of it.

The customer orders, the merchant prepares, a Dasher collects and delivers. Money moves the other way as tips, discounts and refunds. Of the 28.5 minutes a customer waits, 12.5 pass before a Dasher reaches the store. The pages that follow walk this lifecycle in order.



THE PATTERN

Three of the four pain points sit before the food is picked up.

The drive itself is our most consistent stage, at **16.0 minutes** and barely moving across markets or hours.

GROWTH LEVERS

Speed on the first order, Dasher tenure, and merchant ready-time.

Each is examined on the pages that follow, in lifecycle order. Together they are worth more than the **\$11.7K** we currently spend on discounts, which moves repeat rate by **0.2 points**.

PAIN POINT 1

Customers who came back were served faster. Discounts made no difference.

Fulfillment time and refunds, one-time vs repeat customers

Customers who ordered once, against those who ordered again.

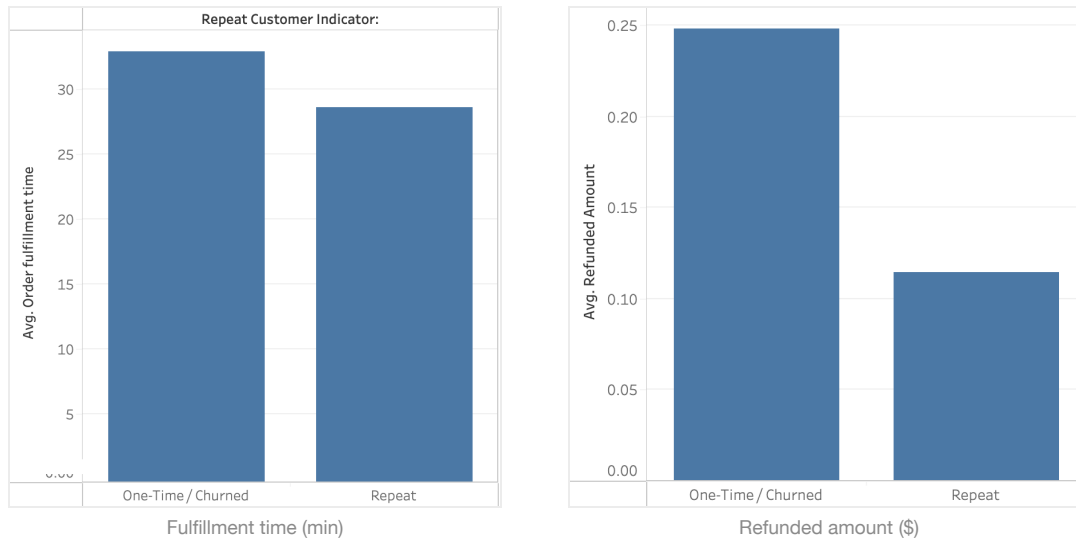


Tableau: "customer retention"

Order total against discount, per customer

Each point is a customer. Both trend lines are flat, so bigger discounts did not produce bigger orders.

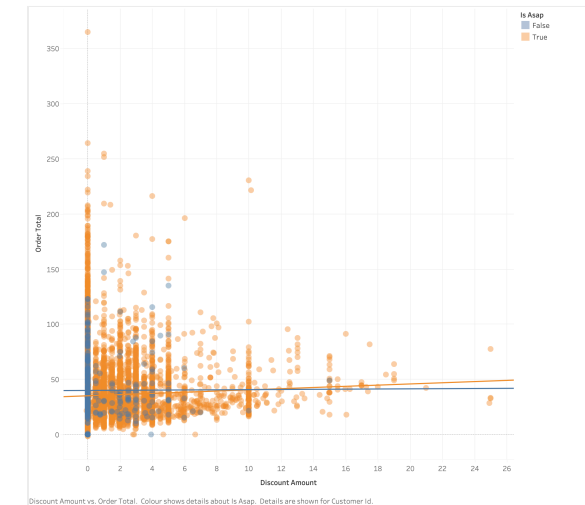


Tableau: "order total vs discount". Coloured by ASAP vs scheduled.

PAIN POINT

76% of customers never come back, and the slow ones leave fastest.

One-time customers waited **32.9 minutes** and were refunded twice as often as repeat customers at 28.6. Repeat rate runs **31.1%** under 20 minutes and **17.7%** over an hour.

GROWTH LEVER · RECOMMENDATION

Move the discount budget into first-order speed.

Discounts shift repeat rate by **0.2 points**. Keep the \$11.7K flat and spend it on peak-hour Dasher pay in our ten slowest markets, run as a market-matched test for six weeks. Closing the gap for the slow-first-order group is worth about **676 more repeat customers** in this sample.

PAIN POINT 2

Across the day and across markets, the drive is steady. Everything before it is not.

Prep time and transit time by hour

Orange bars are prep time, the blue line is transit. Prep swings between 10 and 23 minutes. Transit stays between 12 and 18.

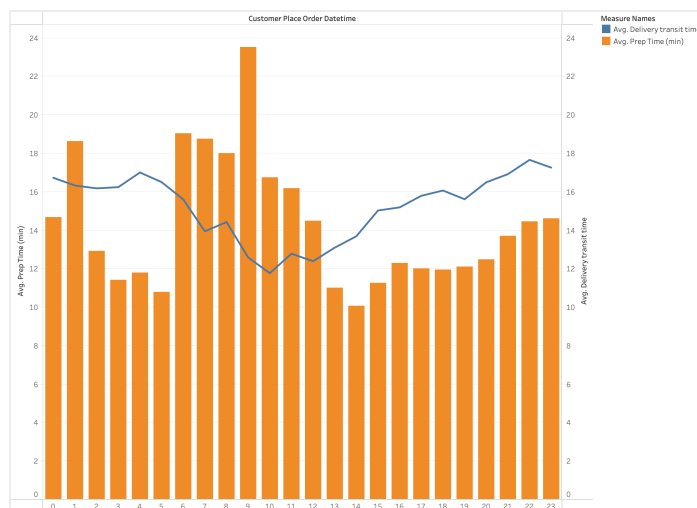


Tableau: "prep vs delivery time". Hour axis is UTC as exported.

Average fulfillment time by market

Worst to best, shaded by transit time. The four markets at the bottom with no bar are not fast, they never completed a delivery.

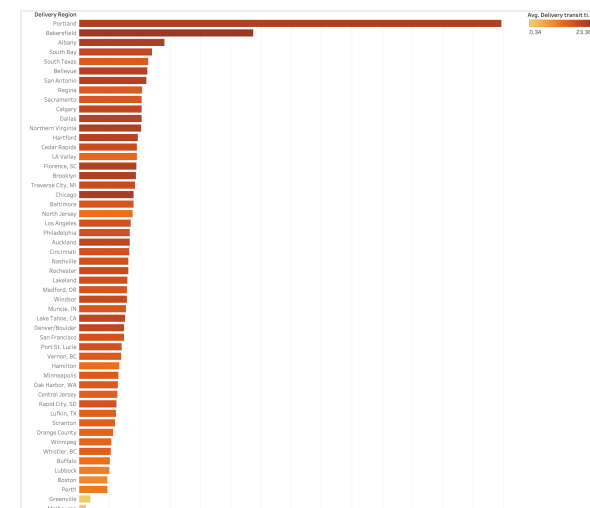


Tableau: "Sheet 5". Portland's 280-minute average comes from a few extreme orders, not normal service.

PAIN POINT

Our slowest markets are more than twice our fastest, all of it before pickup.

Bellevue, San Antonio and Dallas take **41 to 45 minutes**. Lubbock and Whistler take **20 to 21**. Transit is close to flat across all of them.

GROWTH LEVER · RECOMMENDATION

Agree a ready-time standard with the slowest merchants.

The restaurant explains **29.5%** of the variation in pre-pickup time, the largest single factor. Start with the four merchants above 20 minutes. Give them menu-level prep estimates first, then hold to the standard. Target **5 minutes off** in our three slowest markets.

PAIN POINT 3

New Dashers take twice as long to reach the store, and almost all of ours are new

Time to reach the store, by Dasher tenure

Dashers grouped by lifetime deliveries. 8,932 of 9,405 sit in the first group.

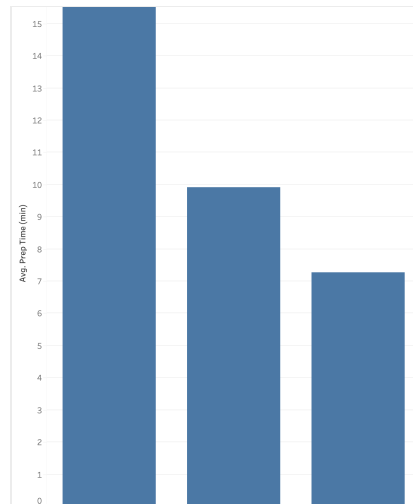


Tableau: "Dasher retention vs prep time". Median lifetime deliveries: 1. Only 70 Dashers reached 21 or more.

Dasher count against transit time, by hour

Transit time is at its highest when we have the most Dashers on the road. Supply is scaling with demand, but service is not holding up.

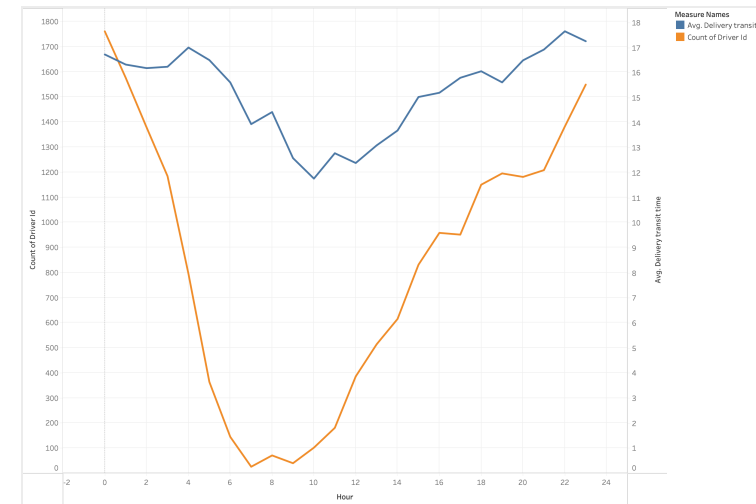


Tableau: "driver availability and delivery time". Hour axis is UTC as exported.

PAIN POINT

We pay the beginner cost on most orders, and five markets had no Dashers at all.

95% of Dashers do five orders or fewer while delivering **68% of volume**. Memphis, Las Vegas, Greenville, Laurinburg and Honolulu took **108 orders and delivered none**.

GROWTH LEVER · RECOMMENDATION

Pay for tenure, not sign-ups. Turn off the five empty markets this week.

An experienced Dasher reaches the store in **7.3 minutes** against **15.5** and finishes the order **10.6 minutes faster**. Put a bonus at the 6th and 21st delivery, where the gain appears, focused on dinner in Bellevue, San Antonio and Dallas. Geo-fence the five empty markets until we can staff them.

PAIN POINT 4

Past fifty minutes the refunds start, and they climb steeply from there

Average refund per order, by total wait

Refunds stay flat and low up to about 40 minutes. After that the line turns sharply upward, and those orders cost us twice: once in refunds, again in customers who do not return.

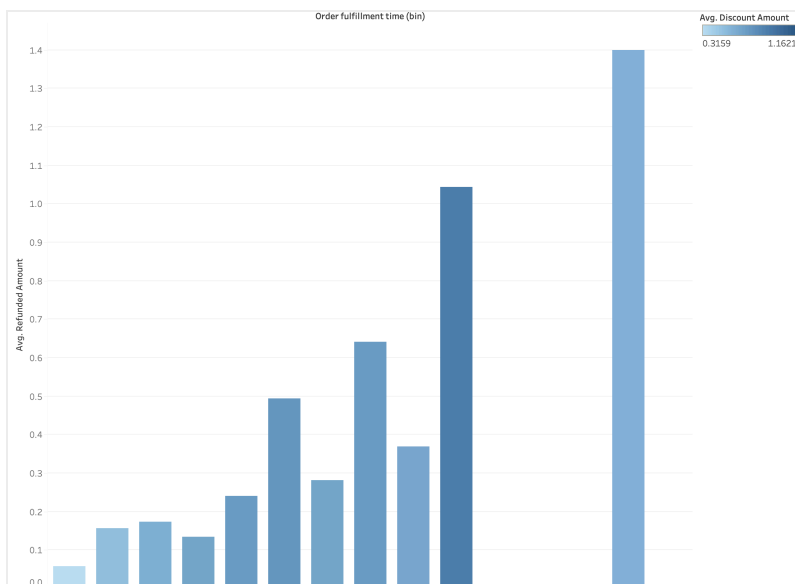


Tableau: "refund by total wait time". Shaded by average discount amount.

6.1%

of orders take longer than 50 minutes

1,170 of 19,168 completed ASAP orders.

15%

of all refund spend comes from them

\$548 of \$3,625, two and a half times their share of volume.

2.8x

the refund cost per order

\$0.47 against \$0.17 inside 50 minutes. Refund incidence goes from 1.3% to 3.1%.

PAIN POINT

A small tail of slow orders carries a large share of the cost.

6.1% of orders produce **15% of refund spend**, before counting the customers those orders lose us.

GROWTH LEVER · RECOMMENDATION

Treat fifty minutes as a hard line and intervene at thirty-five.

Flag and reassign orders at **35 minutes** so fewer reach the point where refunds spike. Set the internal target at **under 40 minutes**, where the curve is still flat, and report the tail rather than the average. Regional Ops, this quarter.

Seven actions, in the order I would do them

WHEN	ACTION	HOW	OWNER	HOW WE KNOW IT WORKED
WEEK 1	Turn off the five markets with no Dashers	Geo-fence Memphis, Las Vegas, Greenville, Laurinburg and Honolulu until we can staff them. Contact the 79 customers whose orders failed.	Regional Ops	No undelivered orders in those markets
WEEKS 1–4	Report ASAP and scheduled orders separately	416 scheduled orders average 142 minutes because their clock starts when the customer books. One filter fixes the baseline.	Analytics	ASAP-only baseline used in the ops review
WEEKS 2–6	Escalate orders at 35 minutes	Flag and reassign before the order crosses 50 minutes, where refund incidence more than doubles.	Regional Ops	Share of orders over 50 min, from 6.1% down
QUARTER 1	Move the discount budget into peak-hour Dasher pay	Keep the \$11.7K flat. Put it into dinner incentives in the ten slowest markets. Run it as a market-matched test for six weeks so the result can be attributed.	Growth + Dasher Ops	Repeat rate for new customers, against a 31% target
QUARTER 1	Add a food-ready timestamp	Splits the 12.5 pre-pickup minutes into merchant wait and Dasher wait, so each side can be given its own target.	Product + Data Eng	Merchant wait and Dasher wait reported separately
QUARTER 1–2	Pay for Dasher tenure	Bonus at the 6th and 21st delivery, where prep time actually drops. Focus on dinner in Bellevue, San Antonio and Dallas.	Dasher Ops	Share of volume from 6+ order Dashers, 32% to 50%
ONGOING	Ready-time standard for the slowest merchants	Restaurant is the largest single factor in the pre-pickup wait, at 29.5% of the variation. Start with the four merchants above 20 minutes. Prep estimates before any penalty.	Merchant Ops	5 minutes off prep in the three slowest markets

Built using native human ingenuity and Tableau, with assembly assistance from Claude Code.



Thank you

Rohan Jauhari

Happy to walk through the analysis or the underlying workbook.